Pre-Flight

Tokens burned. Time lost. Nothing logged.

Sonakshi Pandey

THE PROBLEM

Tiffin runs 6 AI agents calling MCP tool servers through the Databricks AI Gateway.

When a tool rejects a semantically reasonable argument the agent does not fail loudly - it retries, reshapes the argument, guesses, and burns tokens.

These failures return HTTP 200, so conventional error dashboards never see them.

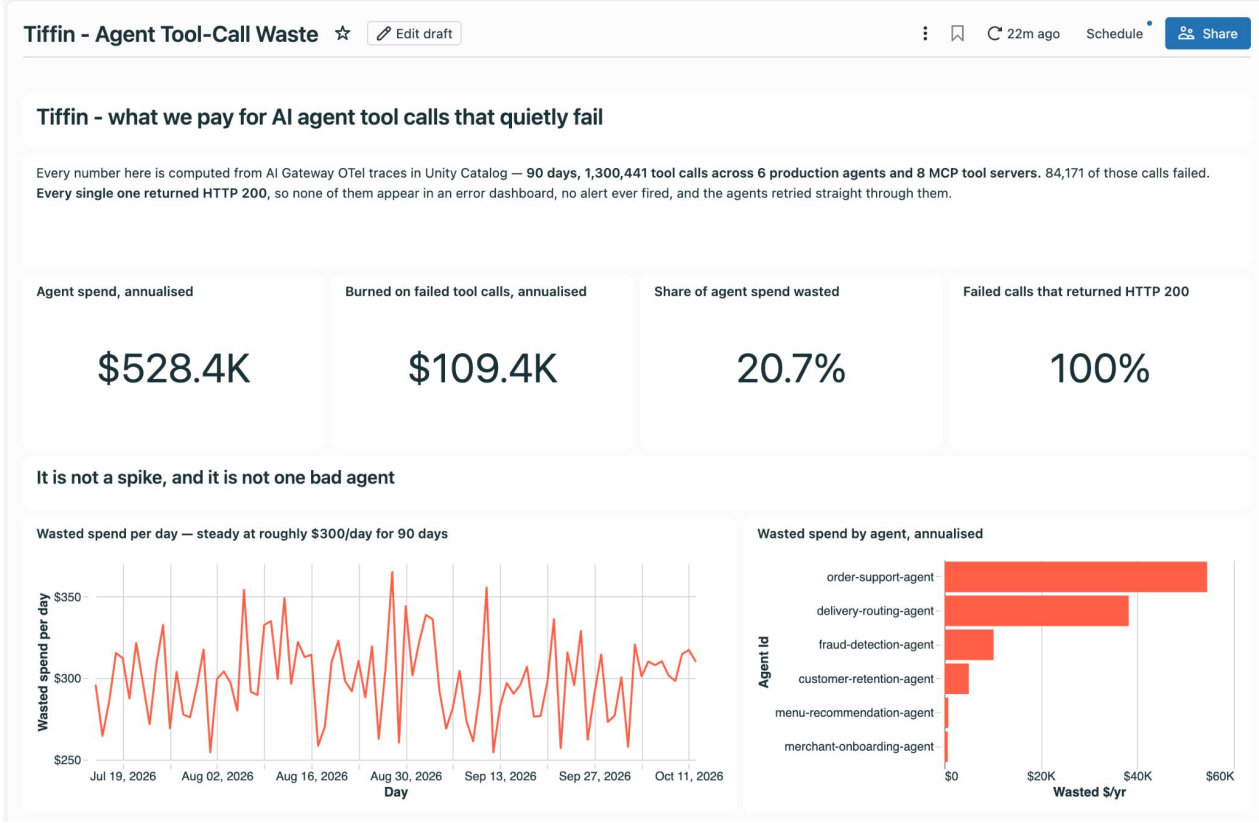
THE SOLUTION - Stop the tokens and time our agents burn on tool calls that fail or retry

A guard model scores every tool call before dispatch and returns a failure probability plus a verdict: coerce, warn, or allow. On coerce the agent rewrites the bad argument from the server's own declared schema — so the failure and its retry loop are prevented at dispatch, not diagnosed afterwards.

VP Engineering: 20.7% of agent spend recovered, agents right instead of confidently wrong. Tool-server owner: a fix queue ranked by dollars — cost per failed call varies 102x.

TIFFIN

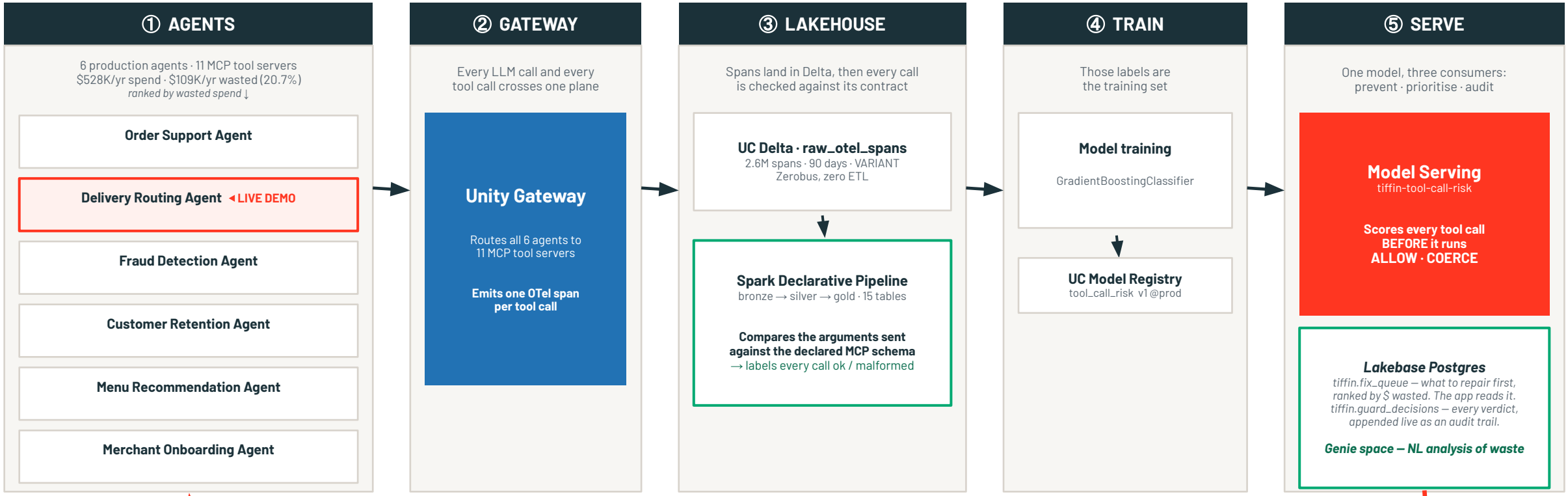
Food-delivery operations · 6 AI agents · 11 MCP tool servers · 109K wasted spend



©2026 Databricks, Inc. — All rights reserved

Six agents. One Gateway. One closed loop.

All six production agents route through the AI Gateway → it emits an OTel span for every tool call → Lakeflow compares the arguments sent against the declared MCP schema → those labels train the model → the model scores the next call before it runs.



⑥ **THE LOOP —** the traces these agents emit train the model that guards those same agents. The verdict comes back before the tool is ever called.

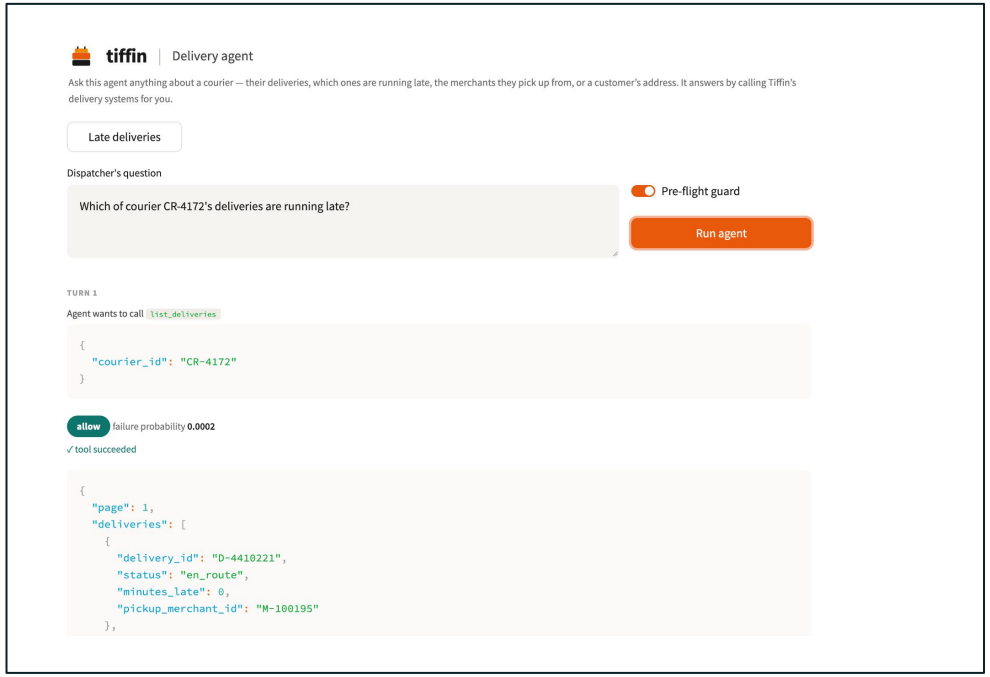
Unity Catalog — one governance plane across all of it: raw spans · 15 pipeline tables · model lineage · serving endpoint · Lakebase Postgres · Genie space

©2026 Databricks, Inc. — All rights reserved

Links



Genie Space



Delivery Agent

REAL — functional today on e2-dogfood
Gateway OTel schema · Lakeflow pipeline (15 tables) · MLflow model + leave-one-bug-family-out eval · UC registry · Model Serving endpoint · Lakebase Postgres · Genie space · Databricks App · AI/BI dashboard
github.com/29sonakshi/tiffin-preflight — code + committed execution evidence

MOCKED — only to make the story demoable
Synthetic Tiffin trace corpus (2.6M spans generated from a seeded bug registry) · 5 in-process MCP tool mocks inside the demo app

©2026 Databricks, Inc. — All rights reserved